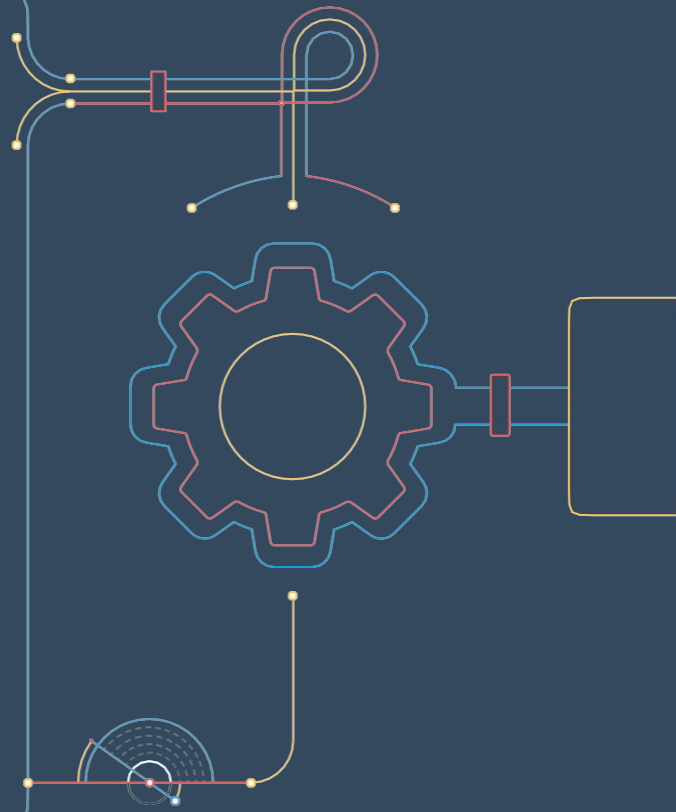
PATHSTREAM

Listings123
Frame A Business Problem



A Understand Listings123

PATHSTREAM

WHO: Who is involved in the problem/project?

- Johnny (Chief Executive Officer)
- Stevie (Analytics Manager)
- Data Analyst (Me)
- The Marketing Team
- Investors/Venture Capitalists
- Listings123's Employees
- Hosts
- Guests

A Understand Listings123

PATHSTREAM

WHAT: What problem has to be solved? What data would you need in order to solve that problem? What would be the ideal solution for that problem? What happens if the problem is not solved?

Listings123 wishes to expand their service to new cities with the proposal to create a marketing campaign to attract new hosts. Johnny currently do not have the budget for the marketing campaign. In order to do so, he needs to convince the investors and VCs for additional funding. To address this problem, it would be important to find data-based evidence indicating what factors make a successful host for Listings123. The ideal solution is to present the data to investors and VCs so that they're confident in offering their funds to go towards the campaign . If unsuccessful, this would lead to the home-sharing service to not be able to expand to new cities, resulting in no growth in new hosts and losing opportunities to grow the overall business. The company may possibly fail or fall short to their other competitors.

WHERE: Where does the problem occur? Where do you need to solve the problem?

The problem occurred within the company's finance department, where the budget is determined. They need to solve the problem within the analytics department.

A Understand Listings123

PATHSTREAM

WHEN: When does the project need to be completed? When does the issue occur?

A solution is needed in 2 weeks. The email from Stevie, indicates the issue occurred recently while preparing for a weekly meeting on it.

WHY: Why should this problem be solved? Why does the issue occur?

This problem needs to be solved to help the service expand to new markets in additional cities. This will also lead to potential new hosts and expansion of the business if they secure the funds. The reasons Listings123 may be encountering this problem could be due to it being a relatively young company and not having adequate resources to have enough data surrounding the problem.

B Understand Listings123's Stakeholders

PATHSTREAM

Who are your stakeholders?

Internal:

- CEO (Johnny)
- Analytics Manager (Stevie)
- Data Analyst (Me)
- The Marketing Team
- Listings123's employees

External:

- Investors/VCs
- Guests
- Hosts

B Understand Listings123's Stakeholders

PATHSTREAM

How is each stakeholder involved? What can each stakeholder contribute to the project?

- Johnny (CEO): Johnny is the leader of the company, which means he has high power on decision-making and high interest. As an analyst, I must make sure to understand his needs and expectations.
- Analytics Manager (Stevie): Stevie began the process of analyzing the company's data. She will support and may advise on decisions. In addition, she provides the sample data to the analyst. I will be directly reporting to the Analytics Manager.
- Data Analyst (Me): I will investigate the data and provide a recommendation to address the problem. A full analysis must be conducted of the data.
- The Marketing Team: They will be collaborating with me to find specific traits. I will be communicating and working with them to help better guide the project with combined knowledge and expertise skills.
- Listings123's employees: The employees are not directly involved in the project. However, they could be negatively impacted if the company doesn't reach their business goals. For instance, there is a possibly the company could fail and they could lose their jobs.

B Understand Listings123's Stakeholders

PATHSTREAM

How is each stakeholder involved? What can each stakeholder contribute to the project? *(continued)*

- Investors/VCs: The investors/VCs provide financial support to the business and have the power to make high-level decision-making. They will need to be convinced on deciding whether they should offer additional funding to the marketing campaign.
- Hosts: Hosts are people looking to rent their homes or rooms by listing it on Listings123. They are not aware that they are directly involved and do not contribute to the project
- Guests: Guests are people looking for temporary accommodations from the hosts' listings on Listings123. They are not aware they are directly involved and do not contribute to the project.

B Understand Listings123's Stakeholders

PATHSTREAM

Why is your project important to each stakeholder?

- **Internal Stakeholders:**
  - The project is important to everyone in the organization for similar goals and reasons in mind. If the company doesn't receive the funding, Listings123 might be forced to close. All the stakeholders under the service would lose their jobs.

B Understand Listings123's Stakeholders

PATHSTREAM

Why is your project important to each stakeholder? *(continued)*

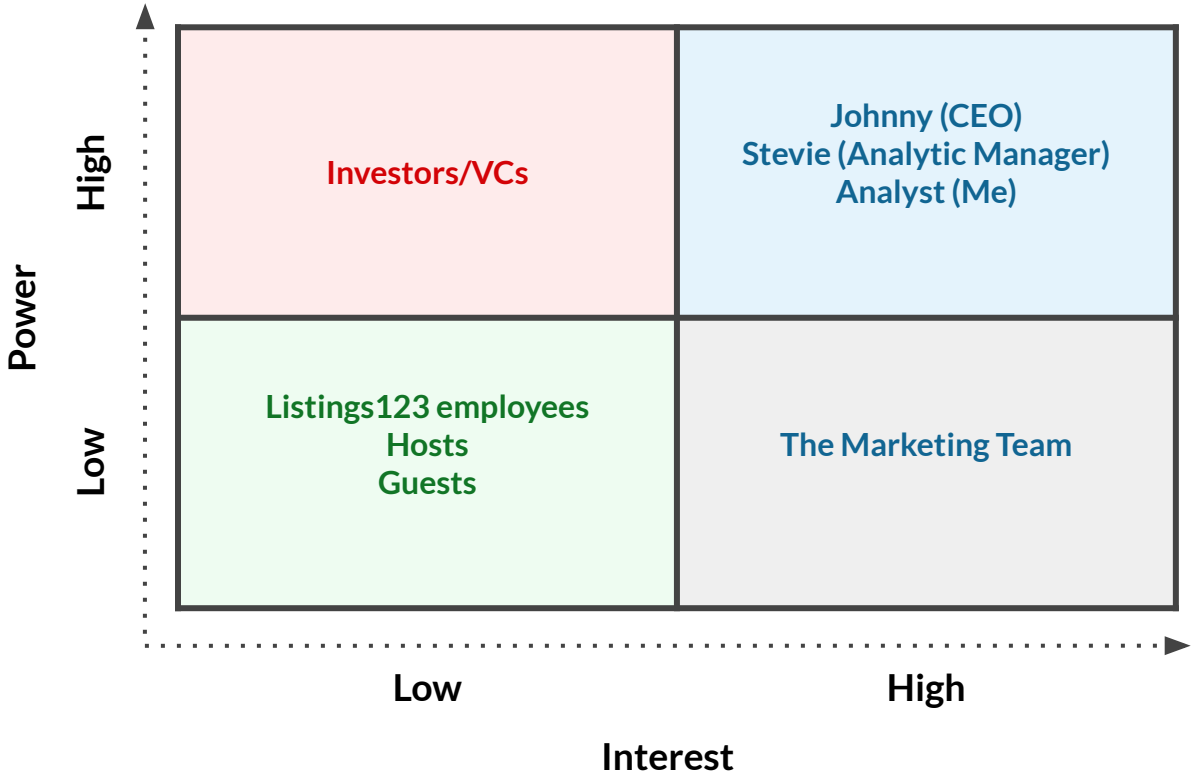
- **External Stakeholders:**
  - Investors/VCs: Listings123 is an investment. If they were to provide the funds for the marketing campaign and the business fails, they will lose their initial investment. It will be a misspend of their resources.
  - Hosts: Hosts could have the opportunity to gain insight on how to succeed with their listing(s). If Listings123 close, the hosts won't be able to use this platform and could lose a source of income. In addition, they would have to find other alternatives to rent their homes.
  - Guests: If Listings123 no longer exist, the guests will not be able to use this online marketplace to find their temporary accommodation.

B Power/Interest Grid (Matrix)

PATHSTREAM

Instructions:

Place each stakeholder in the Listings123 business case into the appropriate quadrant. Refer to slide 5 for the list of stakeholders.



C Explore Listings123's Data

PATHSTREAM

What data do you have access to?

a) How large is your sample data set (in terms of rows and columns)?

Rows: *9*

Columns: **15**

b) What information do your columns contain?

Looking at the sample data, the 15 columns of data contain the following information:
Host ID, City, State, Room Type, Bathrooms, Bedrooms, Beds, Bed Type, Amenities, Price, Cancellation Policy, Number of Reviews, Days Listed, Review Scores Location, and Review Scores Value.

Explore Listings123's Data

PATHSTREAM

What data do you have access to? *(continued)*

c) What data types do your columns contain?

What columns are *qualitative?*
Host ID, City, State, Room Type, Bed Type, Amenities, and Cancellation Policy

What columns are *quantitative*?
Bathrooms, Bedrooms, Beds, Price, Number of Reviews, Days Listed, Review Scores Location, and Review Scores Value

Explore Listings123's Data

PATHSTREAM

What data is important to the problem? Why do you think certain columns are important?

- Data Needed: Host Data, Price Data, Listing Data, Location Data, and Reviews Data
  - Host Data- To identify successful hosts.
  - Price Data- To examine if the hosts' prices are competitive.
  - Listing Data- To analyze the demands and availability of the listings.
  - Location Data- To determine the popularity of which the listings are located.
  - Reviews Data- To see if the guests are satisfied.

Explore Listings123's Data

PATHSTREAM

Is the data enough to solve the problem? If not, what data do you need?

- The data that was given is not enough information.
- It would be beneficial if we had more data on the following:
  - What kind of accommodation (vacation rental, house, cabin, etc.), overview of the neighborhood/area, number of bookings/occupants, how long have they been a host since, host response rate, host acceptance rate, the guests reason for reserving, and how many days the guests stayed.